Hedge Edge

Consolidated Prop-Firm Hedge Model Report

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Data Sources: PropFirmMatch.com

CFD/Forex Challenges Analyzed: 161

Futures Challenges Analyzed: 76

Instant-Funded Offers Analyzed: 63

Total Models Run: 7 (3 FX + 3 Futures + 1 Instant)

Total Opportunities Scored: 720

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1. Executive Summary

This report consolidates the complete Hedge Edge prop-firm analysis across three asset classes (CFD/Forex, Futures, Instant-Funded) and seven hedge model variants (Type A/B/C for FX and Futures, plus Instant-Funded first-payout model). Each model applies a deterministic hedging strategy to evaluate the expected value (EV) of participating in prop-firm challenges.

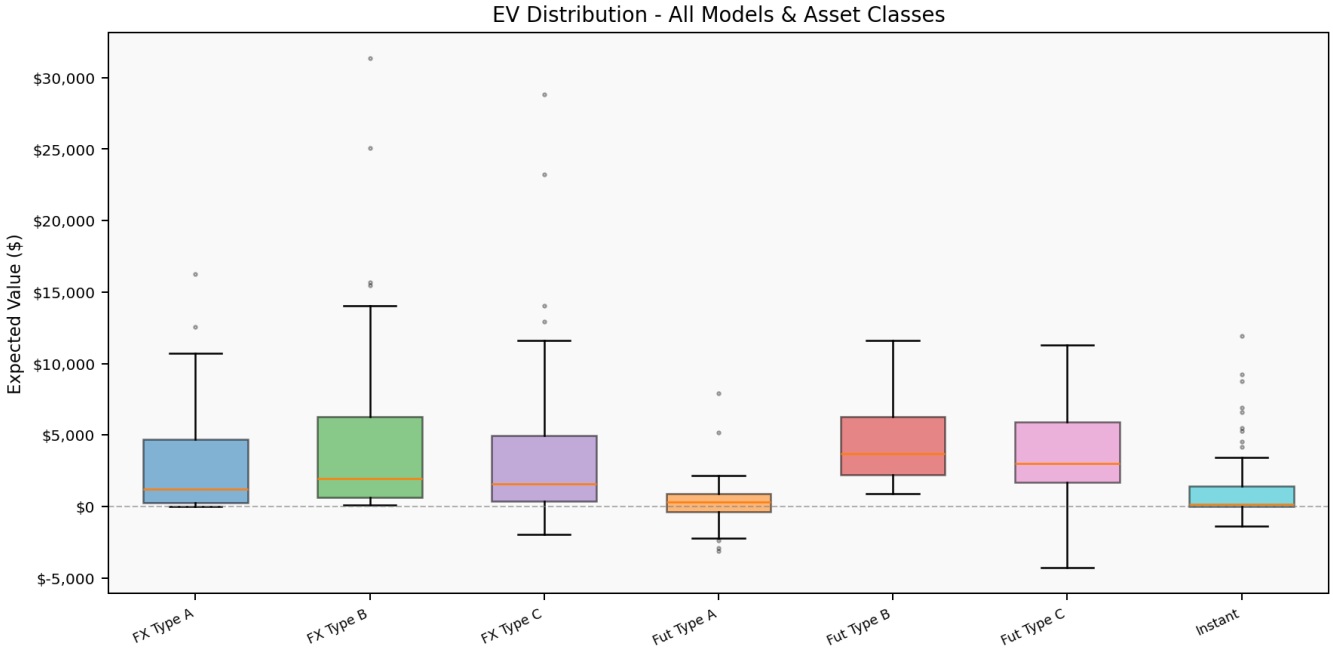
Total Opportunities Scored:	**720**
Positive EV Opportunities:	**678**
Positive EV Rate:	**94.2%**
Best FX EV (Type A):	**$16,264.12**
Best FX EV (Type B):	**$31,358.88**
Best FX EV (Type C):	**$28,848.82**
Best Futures EV (Type A):	**$7,940.40**
Best Futures EV (Type B):	**$11,621.23**
Best Futures EV (Type C):	**$11,304.30**
Best Instant EV:	**$11,912.06**

Key Insight: Funded-continuation models (Type B/C) consistently outperform challenge-only (Type A) models because the hedge recovers historical cost stacks upon funded-account failure. Type C adds a surplus buffer that generates additional recovery on failure, at the cost of proportionally higher hedge drag. Optimal model depends on risk tolerance and capital availability.

2. Cross-Asset Overview

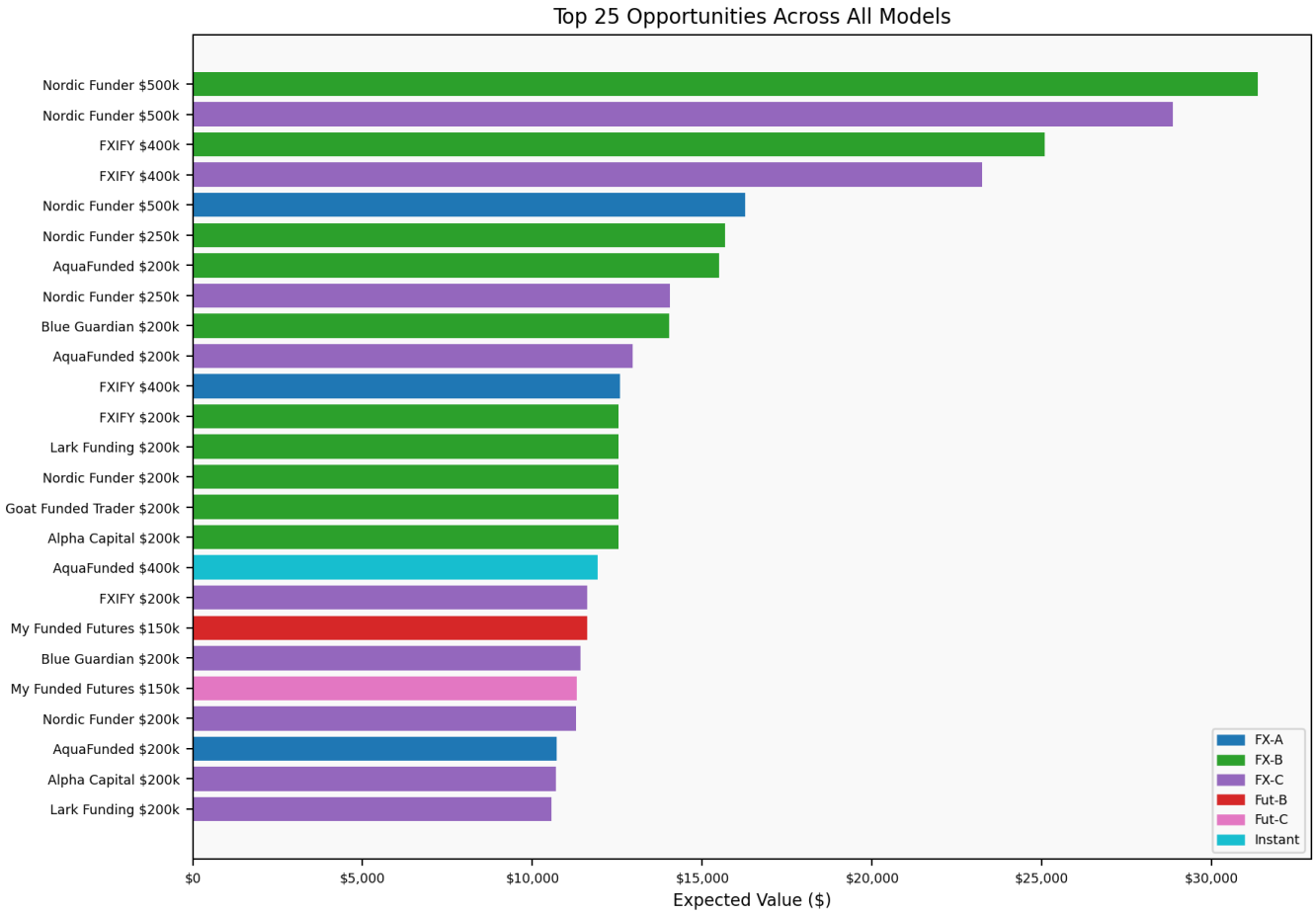
2.1 EV Distribution - All Models

The box plot below shows the EV distribution across all seven model variants. This reveals the spread, central tendency, and outlier characteristics of each model. Models with higher medians and tighter distributions offer more consistent profitability.



2.2 Top 25 Overall Opportunities

The following chart ranks the top 25 individual challenge opportunities across all models and asset classes by EV. Color coding indicates the model type.

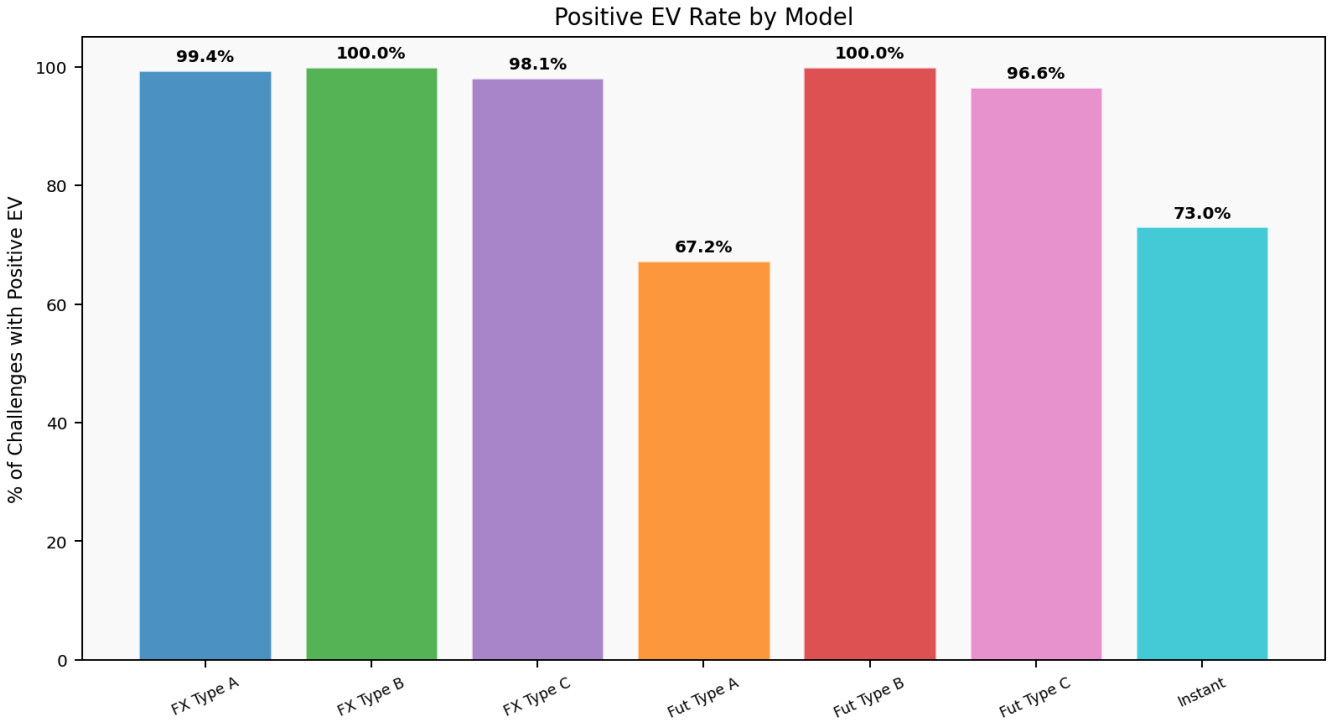


Top 25 Scored Opportunities

Model	Firm	Size	Fee	Ev
FX-B	Nordic Funder	$500,000	$1,932	$31,359
FX-C	Nordic Funder	$500,000	$1,932	$28,849
FX-B	FXIFY	$400,000	$1,599	$25,087
FX-C	FXIFY	$400,000	$1,599	$23,247
FX-A	Nordic Funder	$500,000	$1,932	$16,264
FX-B	Nordic Funder	$250,000	$858	$15,679
FX-B	AquaFunded	$200,000	$677	$15,495
FX-C	Nordic Funder	$250,000	$858	$14,043
FX-B	Blue Guardian	$200,000	$667	$14,019
FX-C	AquaFunded	$200,000	$677	$12,948
FX-A	FXIFY	$400,000	$1,599	$12,576
Instant	AquaFunded	$400,000	$2,699	$11,912
FX-C	FXIFY	$200,000	$799	$11,622
Fut-B	My Funded Futures	$150,000	$347	$11,621
Fut-C	My Funded Futures	$150,000	$347	$11,304
FX-A	AquaFunded	$200,000	$677	$10,725
FX-A	BrightFunded	$200,000	$975	$10,148
Fut-B	Topstep	$150,000	$149	$10,146
FX-A	Blue Guardian	$200,000	$667	$9,979
Fut-C	Topstep	$150,000	$149	$9,486
Fut-B	TradeDay	$150,000	$300	$9,408
Fut-B	The Trading Pit Fu	$150,000	$289	$9,408
Fut-B	Take Profit Trader	$150,000	$360	$9,408
Fut-C	TradeDay	$150,000	$300	$9,289
Instant	Goat Funded Trader	$400,000	$2,998	$9,238

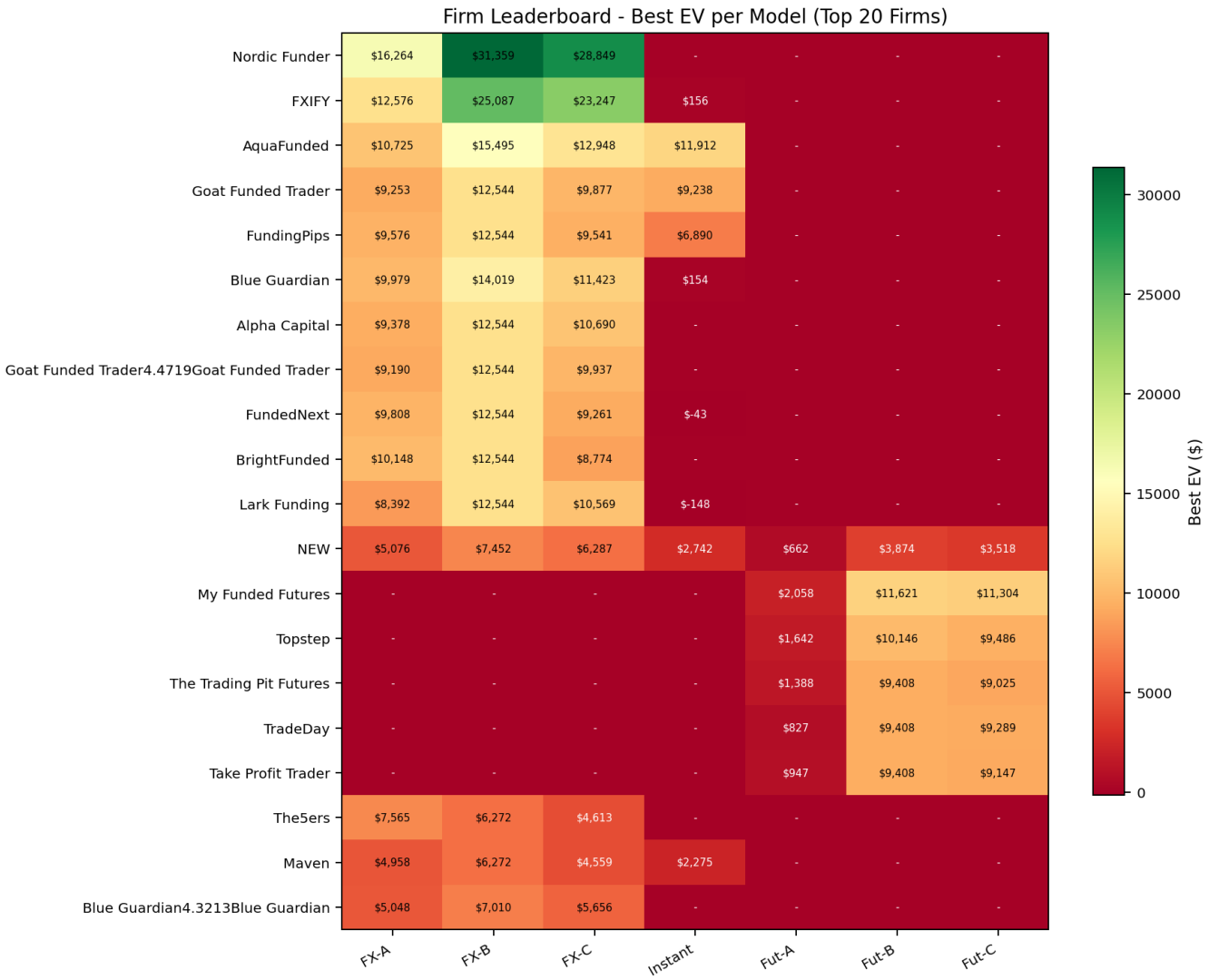
2.3 Positive EV Rates by Model

Not every challenge has positive expected value under the hedge model. The chart below shows what percentage of challenges in each model produce positive EV, indicating the selectivity required.



2.4 Firm Leaderboard Heatmap

This heatmap shows the best EV achieved by each firm across all seven models. Green indicates strong positive EV; red indicates negative or zero. Firms that appear green across multiple columns offer diversified profitability.


Firm Leaderboard - Best EV per Model (Top 20 Firms)
Nordic Funder $16,264 $31,359 $28,849 - - - -
FXIFY $12,576 $25,087 $23,247 $156 - - -
AquaFunded $10,725 $15,495 $12,948 $11,912 - - -
Goat Funded Trader $9,253 $12,544 $9,877 $9,238 - - -
FundingPips $9,576 $12,544 $9,541 $6,890 - - -
Blue Guardian $9,979 $14,019 $11,423 $154 - - -
Alpha Capital $9,378 $12,544 $10,690 - - - -
Goat Funded Trader4.4719Goat Funded Trader $9,190 $12,544 $9,937 - - - -
FundedNext $9,808 $12,544 $9,261 $-43 - - -
BrightFunded $10,148 $12,544 $8,774 - - - -
Lark Funding $8,392 $12,544 $10,569 $-148 - - -
NEW $5,076 $7,452 $6,287 $2,742 $662 $3,874 $3,518
My Funded Futures - - - - $2,058 $11,621 $11,304
Topstep - - - - $1,642 $10,146 $9,486
The Trading Pit Futures - - - - $1,388 $9,408 $9,025
TradeDay - - - - $827 $9,408 $9,289
Take Profit Trader - - - - $947 $9,408 $9,147
The5ers $7,565 $6,272 $4,613 - - - -
Maven $4,958 $6,272 $4,559 $2,275 - - -
Blue Guardian4.3213Blue Guardian $5,048 $7,010 $5,656 - - - -
FX-A
FX-B
FX-C
Instant
Fut-A
Fut-B
Fut-C
Best EV ($)
30000
25000
20000
15000
10000
5000
0

3. CFD/Forex Deep Dive

The CFD/Forex dataset contains 161 challenges from PropFirmMatch. These are traditional FX prop-firm challenges where profit targets and drawdowns are expressed as percentages of account size. The hedge uses leveraged FX positions with a 3-pip spread model.

3.1 Type A - Challenge Insurance

Type A is a challenge-only hedge. The trader opens a hedge position that grows in proportion to the challenge cost (insured base). If the challenge fails, the hedge profits, recovering the fee. EV = funded_payout - total_cost. Parameters: 8% funded target, 3-pip spread, 20 daily resizes for trailing.

Top 20 - FX Type A Rankings

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Dd Category	Total Cost	Funded Payout	Ev	Capital Efficie
Nordic Funder	500000	$1,932	static	$15,736	$32,000	$16,264	0.6080
FXIFY	400000	$1,599	static	$13,024	$25,600	$12,576	0.5680
AquaFunded	200000	$677	static	$3,675	$14,400	$10,725	1.80
BrightFunded	200000	$975	static	$2,652	$12,800	$10,148	2.39
Blue Guardian	200000	$667	static	$3,621	$13,600	$9,979	1.70
FundedNext	200000	$1,100	static	$2,992	$12,800	$9,808	2.05
FundingPips	200000	$798	static	$3,224	$12,800	$9,576	1.78
Alpha Capital	200000	$847	static	$3,422	$12,800	$9,378	1.64
Goat Funded Trader	200000	$1,174	static	$3,547	$12,800	$9,253	1.63
Goat Funded Trader	200000	$665	static	$3,610	$12,800	$9,190	1.57
Nordic Funder	250000	$858	static	$6,984	$16,000	$9,016	0.7593
Lark Funding	200000	$750	static	$4,408	$12,800	$8,392	1.12
Alpha Capital	200000	$697	static	$4,592	$12,800	$8,208	1.07
The5ers	250000	$225	static	$2,435	$10,000	$7,565	1.83
Goat Funded Trader	150000	$728	static	$2,112	$9,600	$7,488	2.22
Nordic Funder	200000	$700	static	$5,701	$12,800	$7,099	0.7324
FXIFY	200000	$799	static	$6,508	$12,800	$6,292	0.5688
AquaFunded	100000	$429	static	$1,296	$7,200	$5,904	2.85
Blue Guardian	100000	$464	static	$1,309	$6,800	$5,491	2.62
FundedElite	100000	$299	static	$1,102	$6,400	$5,298	2.96

FX Type A Summary: 161 challenges scored | Positive EV: 160 (99.4%) | Mean EV: $2,739.77 | Median EV: $1,233.01 | Max EV: $16,264.12 | Std Dev: $3,059.03

3.2 Type B - Funded Recovery

Type B extends the hedge into the funded phase. After passing the challenge, the hedge continues to run during funded trading. If the funded account fails, the hedge recovers the accumulated cost stack. Meanwhile, each cycle the trader withdraws profits. EV_B = total_withdrawals - total_drag. Parameters: 4% withdrawal/cycle, 6 cycles, 80% survival rate, 1.5% hedge drag.

Top 20 - FX Type B Rankings

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Type A Ev	Ev B	Ev Advantage	Capital Efficie
Nordic Funder	500000	$1,932	$16,264	$31,359	$15,095	0.3037
FXIFY	400000	$1,599	$12,576	$25,087	$12,511	0.3010
Nordic Funder	250000	$858	$9,016	$15,679	$6,664	0.3128
AquaFunded	200000	$677	$10,725	$15,495	$4,770	0.4399
Blue Guardian	200000	$667	$9,979	$14,019	$4,040	0.3990
Alpha Capital	200000	$847	$9,378	$12,544	$3,166	0.3513
FXIFY	200000	$799	$6,292	$12,544	$6,251	0.3011
Lark Funding	200000	$750	$8,392	$12,544	$4,151	0.3293
Nordic Funder	200000	$700	$7,099	$12,544	$5,445	0.3113
Goat Funded Trader	200000	$1,174	$9,253	$12,544	$3,290	0.3638
FundingPips	200000	$798	$9,576	$12,544	$2,968	0.3546
FundedNext	200000	$1,100	$9,808	$12,544	$2,735	0.3735
BrightFunded	200000	$975	$10,148	$12,544	$2,395	0.3796
Goat Funded Trader	200000	$665	$9,190	$12,544	$3,354	0.3572
Alpha Capital	200000	$697	$8,208	$12,544	$4,335	0.3331
Goat Funded Trader	150000	$728	$7,488	$9,408	$1,919	0.3766
AquaFunded	100000	$377	$5,153	$7,747	$2,594	0.4316
AquaFunded	100000	$429	$5,904	$7,747	$1,844	0.4703
NEW	100000	$650	$5,076	$7,452	$2,376	0.4248
Blue Guardian4.321	100000	$579	$5,048	$7,010	$1,962	0.4012

FX Type B Summary: 161 challenges scored | Positive EV: 161 (100.0%) | Mean EV: $4,031.99 | Median EV: $1,936.87 | Mean Advantage vs A: $1,292.23

3.3 Type C - Funded Surplus

Type C adds a surplus buffer (2% of account size) that the hedge also covers. On funded-account failure, the hedge recovers the cost stack PLUS the surplus. This increases drag proportionally but provides additional income on failure. EV_C = withdrawals + expected_surplus - drag.

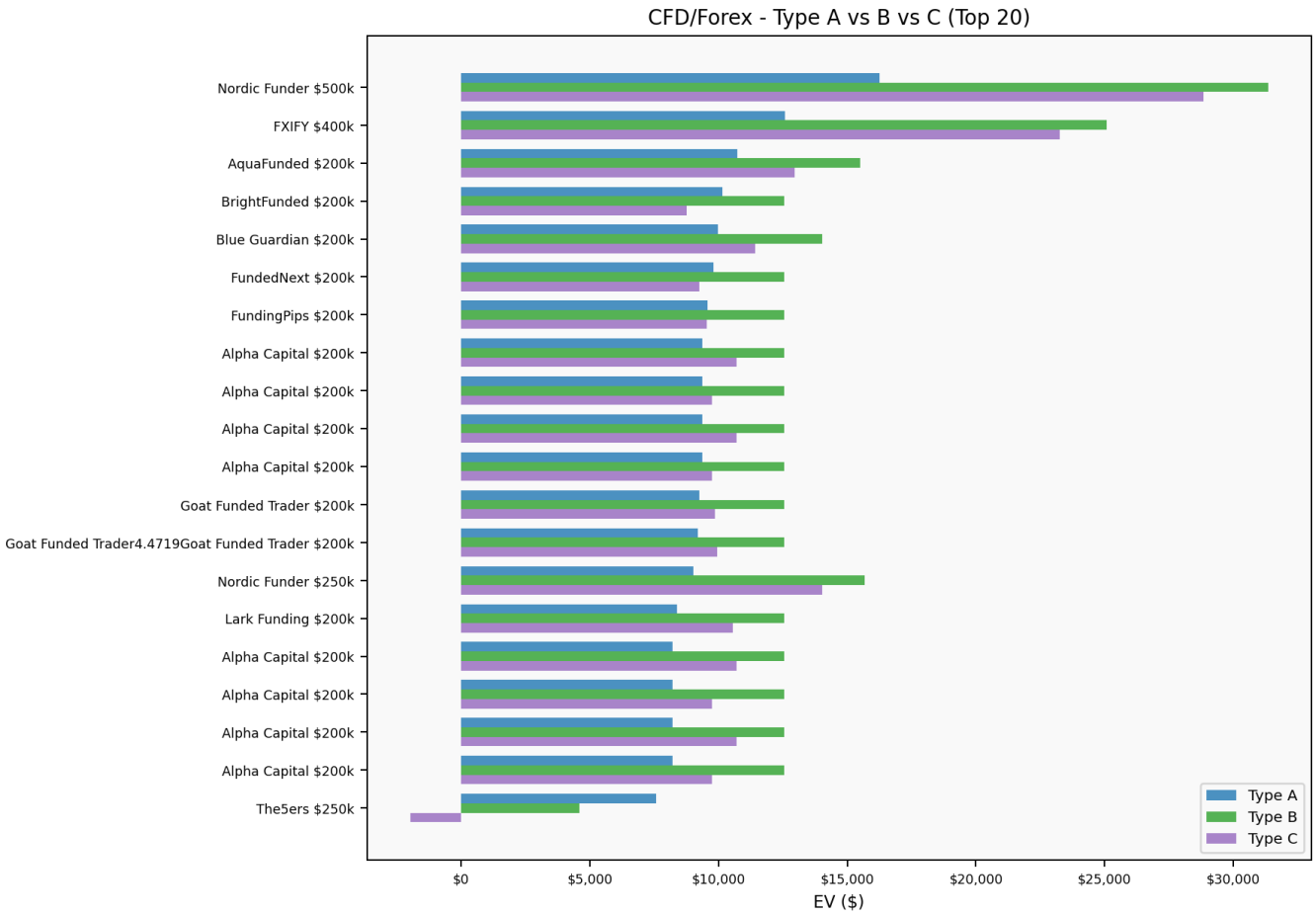
Top 20 - FX Type C Rankings

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Type A Ev	Ev C	Ev Advantage	Expected Surplu	Capital Efficie
Nordic Funder	500000	$1,932	$16,264	$28,849	$12,585	$7,379	0.2016
FXIFY	400000	$1,599	$12,576	$23,247	$10,671	$5,903	0.2023
Nordic Funder	250000	$858	$9,016	$14,043	$5,027	$3,689	0.1984
AquaFunded	200000	$677	$10,725	$12,948	$2,224	$2,951	0.2437
FXIFY	200000	$799	$6,292	$11,622	$5,330	$2,951	0.2023
Blue Guardian	200000	$667	$9,979	$11,423	$1,444	$2,951	0.2150
Nordic Funder	200000	$700	$7,099	$11,287	$4,189	$2,951	0.1990
Alpha Capital	200000	$697	$8,208	$10,690	$2,482	$2,951	0.1950
Lark Funding	200000	$750	$8,392	$10,569	$2,177	$2,951	0.1893
Goat Funded Trader	200000	$665	$9,190	$9,937	$747	$2,951	0.1871
Goat Funded Trader	200000	$1,174	$9,253	$9,877	$624	$2,951	0.1889
Alpha Capital	200000	$847	$9,378	$9,754	$375	$2,951	0.1791
FundingPips	200000	$798	$9,576	$9,541	-35.05	$2,951	0.1751
FundedNext	200000	$1,100	$9,808	$9,261	$-547	$2,951	0.1768
BrightFunded	200000	$975	$10,148	$8,774	$-1,374	$2,951	0.1668
Goat Funded Trader	150000	$728	$7,488	$6,766	$-722	$2,214	0.1719
AquaFunded	100000	$377	$5,153	$6,648	$1,494	$1,476	0.2498
NEW	100000	$650	$5,076	$6,287	$1,211	$1,476	0.2402
Top One Trader	100000	$998	$2,722	$5,957	$3,235	$1,476	0.2137
Blue Guardian	100000	$367	$4,808	$5,868	$1,060	$1,476	0.2206

FX Type C Summary: 161 challenges scored | Positive EV: 158 (98.1%) | Mean EV: $3,252.56 | Mean Surplus Recovery: $970.67

3.4 CFD/Forex - A vs B vs C Comparison

The grouped bar chart below compares the EV of all three model types for the top 20 FX challenges. Type B consistently outperforms Type A as funded withdrawals exceed hedge drag. Type C provides marginal improvement over B via surplus recovery.


CFD/Forex - Type A vs B vs C (Top 20)
Nordic Funder $500k
FXIFY $400k
AquaFunded $200k
BrightFunded $200k
Blue Guardian $200k
FundedNext $200k
FundingPips $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
Goat Funded Trader $200k
Goat Funded Trader4.4719Goat Funded Trader $200k
Nordic Funder $250k
Lark Funding $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
Alpha Capital $200k
The5ers $250k
Type A
Type B
Type C
$0
$5,000
$10,000
$15,000
$20,000
$25,000
$30,000
EV ($)

4. Futures Deep Dive

The Futures dataset contains 76 challenges across account sizes from $25K to $300K. Futures challenges differ from FX: profit targets and drawdowns are in dollar amounts, spread is fixed per contract ($5/RT), and payout caps are common. Consistency rules often apply.

4.1 Type A - Futures Challenge Insurance

The futures Type A model accounts for per-contract spread costs, trailing/static drawdown mechanics, consistency-rule-driven trading days, and payout caps. Parameters: 6% funded target, $5/contract spread.

Top 20 - Futures Type A Rankings

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Dd Type	Payout Cap	Total Cost	Ev	Capital Efficie
Traders Launch	$300,000	$139	trailing	0.0000	$1,960	$7,940	1.99
Traders Launch	$200,000	74.00	trailing	0.0000	$1,446	$5,154	2.58
Alpha Futures	$150,000	$239	trailing	$15,000	$4,161	$2,139	0.0713
My Funded Futures	$150,000	$347	trailing	$100,000	$6,042	$2,058	0.0686
FundedNext Futures	$100,000	$250	trailing	0.0000	$2,846	$1,954	0.1954
Topstep	$100,000	99.00	trailing	$5,000	$3,358	$1,642	0.0821
The Trading Pit Fu	$150,000	$289	trailing	$500,050	$5,812	$1,388	0.0463
Alpha Futures	$100,000	$159	trailing	$15,000	$2,823	$1,377	0.0689
Topstep	$50,000	49.00	trailing	$5,000	$1,362	$1,338	0.1338
Top One Futures	$50,000	$105	trailing	$2,500	$1,183	$1,317	0.2195
Traders Launch	$100,000	49.00	trailing	0.0000	$2,119	$1,181	0.1181
My Funded Futures	$100,000	$267	trailing	$100,000	$4,249	$1,151	0.0575
My Funded Futures	$50,000	$107	trailing	$5,000	$1,448	$952	0.0952
Take Profit Trader	$150,000	$360	trailing	0.0000	$6,253	$947	0.0316
The Trading Pit Fu	$100,000	$189	trailing	$500,050	$3,895	$905	0.0452
AquaFutures	$150,000	$285	trailing	$4,500	$3,609	$891	0.0495
The Trading Pit Fu	$50,000	99.00	trailing	$500,050	$1,545	$855	0.0855
TradeDay	$100,000	$200	trailing	$20,000	$3,973	$827	0.0413
TradeDay	$50,000	$125	trailing	$20,000	$1,660	$740	0.0740
Top One Futures	$25,000	69.00	trailing	$1,500	$631	$719	0.3594

Futures Type A Summary: 58 challenges scored | Positive EV: 39 (67.2%) | Mean EV: $355.75 | Max EV: $7,940.40

4.2 Type B - Futures Recovery

Futures Type B extends the hedge into the funded phase with the same recovery mechanics as FX Type B, but respects payout caps on withdrawals.

Top 20 - Futures Type B Rankings

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Payout Cap	Type A Ev	Ev B	Ev Advantage
My Funded Futures	$150,000	$347	$100,000	$2,058	$11,621	$9,564
Topstep	$150,000	$149	$5,000	34.63	$10,146	$10,111
Take Profit Trader	$150,000	$360	0.0000	$947	$9,408	$8,460
The Trading Pit Fu	$150,000	$289	$500,050	$1,388	$9,408	$8,020
TradeDay	$150,000	$300	$20,000	$372	$9,408	$9,036
AquaFutures	$150,000	$285	$4,500	$891	$8,301	$7,409
Topstep	$100,000	99.00	$5,000	$1,642	$7,747	$6,105
My Funded Futures	$100,000	$267	$100,000	$1,151	$7,747	$6,597
Traders Launch	$300,000	$139	0.0000	$7,940	$7,747	$-193
Alpha Futures	$150,000	$239	$15,000	$2,139	$7,194	$5,056
Earn2Trade	$150,000	$375	$4,000	$-2,355	$6,456	$8,811
Blue Guardian Futu	$150,000	$269	$4,000	$-1,758	$6,456	$8,215
Earn2Trade	$100,000	$315	$4,000	$-378	$6,272	$6,650
The Trading Pit Fu	$100,000	$189	$500,050	$905	$6,272	$5,367
Take Profit Trader	$100,000	$330	0.0000	$-488	$6,272	$6,760
FundedNext Futures	$100,000	$250	0.0000	$1,954	$6,272	$4,318
TradeDay	$100,000	$200	$20,000	$827	$6,272	$5,445
Top One Futures	$100,000	$209	$3,000	$259	$5,534	$5,275
AquaFutures	$100,000	$195	$3,000	$698	$5,534	$4,836
E8 Futures	$150,000	$390	$3,750	$-264	$5,534	$5,798

Futures Type B Summary: 58 scored | Positive EV: 58 (100.0%) | Mean EV: $4,398.51

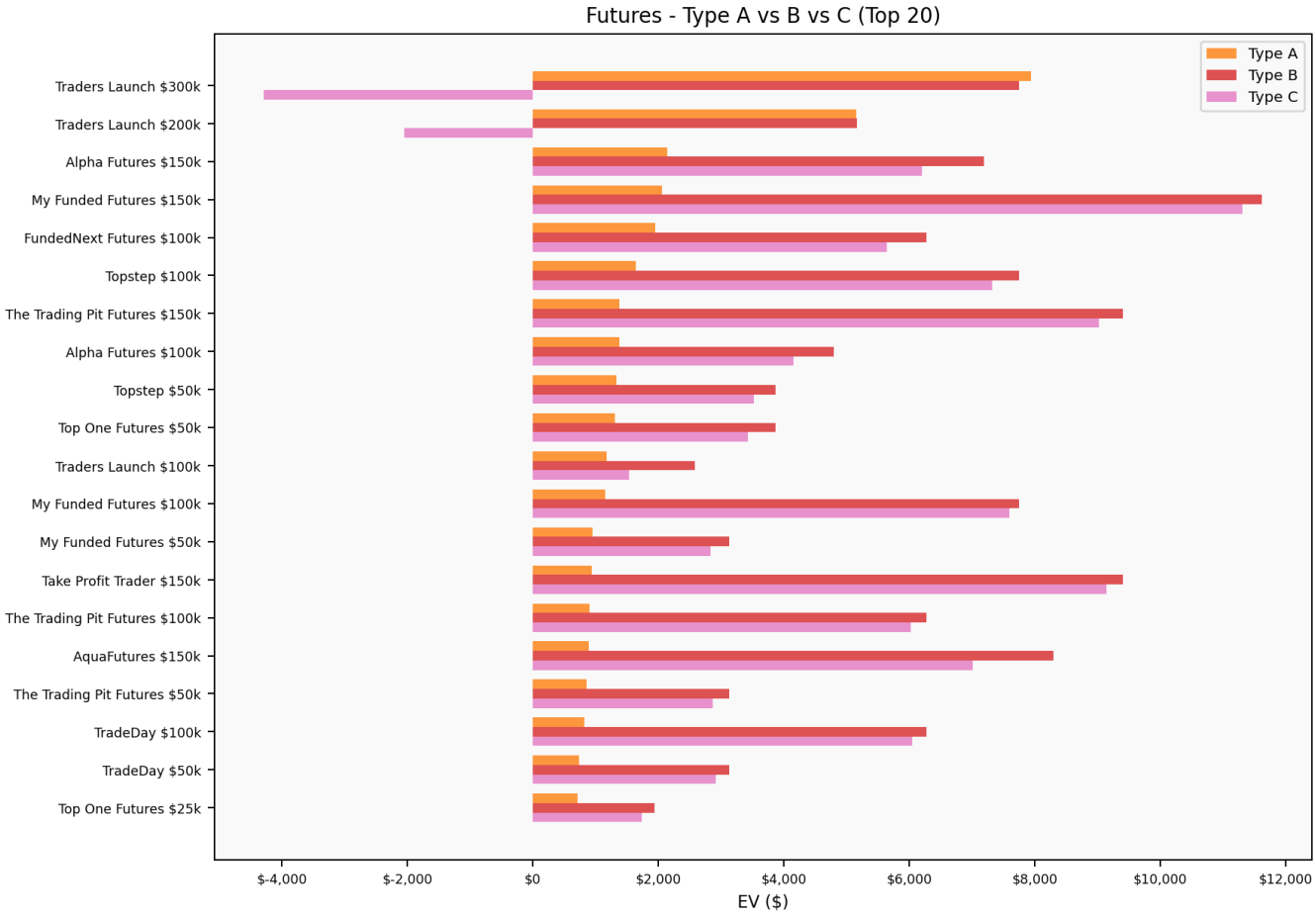
4.3 Type C - Futures Surplus

Top 20 - Futures Type C Rankings

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Type A Ev	Ev C	Ev Advantage	Expected Surplu
My Funded Futures	$150,000	$347	$2,058	$11,304	$9,247	$2,214
Topstep	$150,000	$149	34.63	$9,486	$9,451	$2,214
TradeDay	$150,000	$300	$372	$9,289	$8,918	$2,214
Take Profit Trader	$150,000	$360	$947	$9,147	$8,200	$2,214
The Trading Pit Fu	$150,000	$289	$1,388	$9,025	$7,638	$2,214
My Funded Futures	$100,000	$267	$1,151	$7,595	$6,444	$1,476
Topstep	$100,000	99.00	$1,642	$7,325	$5,683	$1,476
AquaFutures	$150,000	$285	$891	$7,012	$6,120	$2,214
Take Profit Trader	$100,000	$330	$-488	$6,345	$6,833	$1,476
Earn2Trade	$150,000	$375	$-2,355	$6,222	$8,577	$2,214
Alpha Futures	$150,000	$239	$2,139	$6,198	$4,060	$2,214
Earn2Trade	$100,000	$315	$-378	$6,151	$6,529	$1,476
Blue Guardian Futu	$150,000	$269	$-1,758	$6,058	$7,816	$2,214
TradeDay	$100,000	$200	$827	$6,045	$5,218	$1,476
The Trading Pit Fu	$100,000	$189	$905	$6,023	$5,118	$1,476
FundedNext Futures	$100,000	$250	$1,954	$5,641	$3,687	$1,476
Top One Futures	$100,000	$209	$259	$4,854	$4,595	$1,476
Take Profit Trader	$75,000	$245	70.79	$4,671	$4,600	$1,107
AquaFutures	$100,000	$195	$698	$4,611	$3,913	$1,476
E8 Futures	$150,000	$390	$-264	$4,466	$4,730	$2,214

Futures Type C Summary: 58 scored | Positive EV: 56 (96.6%) | Mean EV: $3,673.45

4.4 Futures - A vs B vs C Comparison



5. Instant-Funded Deep Dive

The Instant-Funded dataset contains 63 offers filtered from FX challenges (steps_label = 'Instant'). These skip the evaluation phase entirely - traders begin funded immediately. The model targets a 5% first payout with a consistency-driven minimum trading period. Parameters: 5% payout target, 3-pip spread, 5-day base period, 100x leverage.

Top 20 - Instant-Funded Rankings

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Effective Dd T	Max Dd Pc	Profit Split P	Trading Da	Funded Payout	Total Cost	Ev	Capital Efficie
AquaFunded	$400,000	$2,699	trailing	6.00	90.00	5	$18,000	$6,088	$11,912	9.21
Goat Funded Trader	$400,000	$2,998	trailing	6.00	80.00	5	$16,000	$6,762	$9,238	6.43
AquaFunded	$300,000	$2,099	trailing	6.00	90.00	5	$13,500	$4,735	$8,765	8.71
FundingPips	$200,000	$998	trailing	5.00	95.00	5	$9,500	$2,610	$6,890	10.66
Goat Funded Trader	$300,000	$2,398	trailing	6.00	80.00	5	$12,000	$5,409	$6,591	5.74
AquaFunded	$200,000	$1,265	static	3.00	90.00	5	$9,000	$3,500	$5,500	8.70
Goat Funded Trader	$250,000	$2,088	trailing	6.00	80.00	5	$10,000	$4,710	$5,290	5.29
AquaFunded	$150,000	$980	trailing	6.00	90.00	5	$6,750	$2,211	$4,539	9.67
Goat Funded Trader	$200,000	$1,708	trailing	6.00	80.00	5	$8,000	$3,853	$4,147	5.07
FundingPips	$100,000	$499	trailing	5.00	95.00	5	$4,750	$1,305	$3,445	10.66
Goat Funded Trader	$150,000	$1,198	trailing	6.00	80.00	5	$6,000	$2,702	$3,298	5.74
NEW	$100,000	$735	trailing	6.00	88.00	5	$4,400	$1,658	$2,742	7.78
AquaFunded	$100,000	$767	static	3.00	90.00	5	$4,500	$2,122	$2,378	6.20
Maven	$100,000	$380	trailing	3.00	80.00	5	$4,000	$1,725	$2,275	3.57
Goat Funded Trader	$100,000	$858	static	4.00	80.00	5	$4,000	$1,995	$2,005	6.23
FundingPips	$50,000	$299	trailing	5.00	95.00	5	$2,375	$782	$1,593	8.23
Blueberry Funded	$100,000	$850	trailing	4.00	80.00	5	$4,000	$2,753	$1,247	1.53
NEW	$50,000	$465	trailing	6.00	88.00	5	$2,200	$1,049	$1,151	5.17
Maven	$50,000	$190	trailing	3.00	80.00	5	$2,000	$863	$1,137	3.57
Top One Trader	$50,000	$410	trailing	5.00	80.00	5	$2,000	$1,072	$928	3.50

Instant-Funded Summary: 63 offers scored | Positive EV: 46 (73.0%) | Mean EV: $1,396.25 | Max EV: $11,912.06 | Avg Capital Required: $256.53

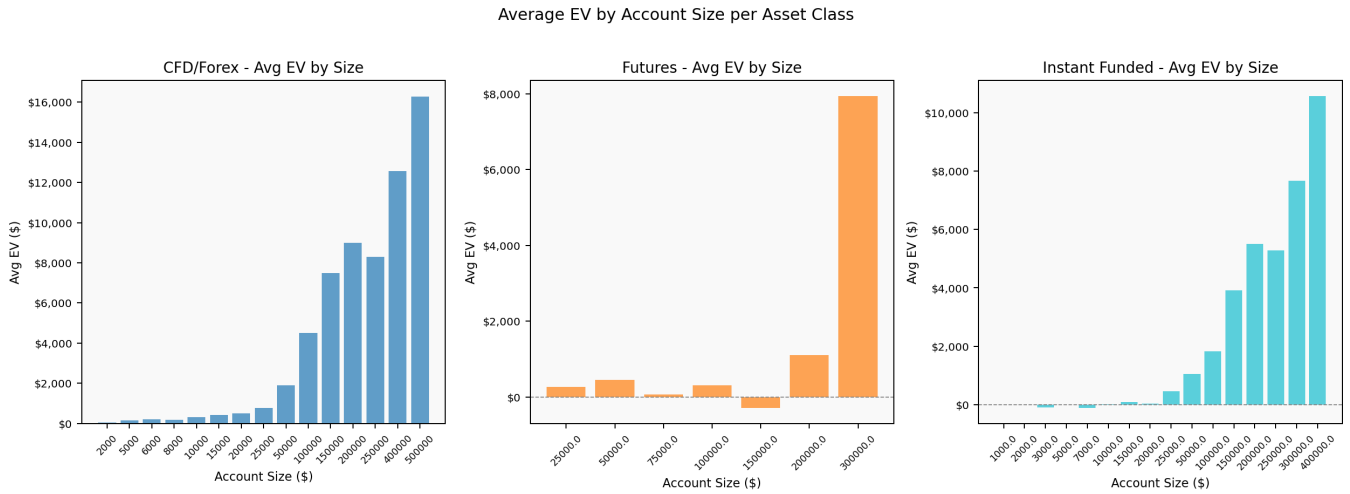
Instant-Funded: EV by Drawdown Type

Dd Type	Mean Ev	Median Ev	Count	Std Dev
static	$483	41.90	17	$1,547
trailing	$1,734	$337	46	$2,863

6. Statistical Analysis

6.1 EV by Account Size

Larger account sizes generally yield higher absolute EV due to larger funded payouts, but fees also scale. The chart below shows average EV by account size for each asset class.



CFD/Forex - EV by Account Size

Size	Count	Mean Ev	Median Ev	Max Ev	Pos %
$2,000	2.00	43.29	43.29	65.73	$100
$5,000	31.00	$164	$180	$272	96.77
$6,000	3.00	$201	$217	$221	$100
$8,000	1.00	$186	$186	$186	$100
$10,000	17.00	$308	$327	$478	$100
$15,000	5.00	$433	$386	$634	$100
$20,000	3.00	$510	$562	$654	$100
$25,000	16.00	$786	$831	$1,176	$100
$50,000	17.00	$1,893	$2,125	$2,398	$100
$100,000	49.00	$4,500	$4,679	$5,904	$100
$150,000	1.00	$7,488	$7,488	$7,488	$100
$200,000	12.00	$9,004	$9,316	$10,725	$100
$250,000	2.00	$8,290	$8,290	$9,016	$100
$400,000	1.00	$12,576	$12,576	$12,576	$100
$500,000	1.00	$16,264	$16,264	$16,264	$100

Futures - EV by Account Size

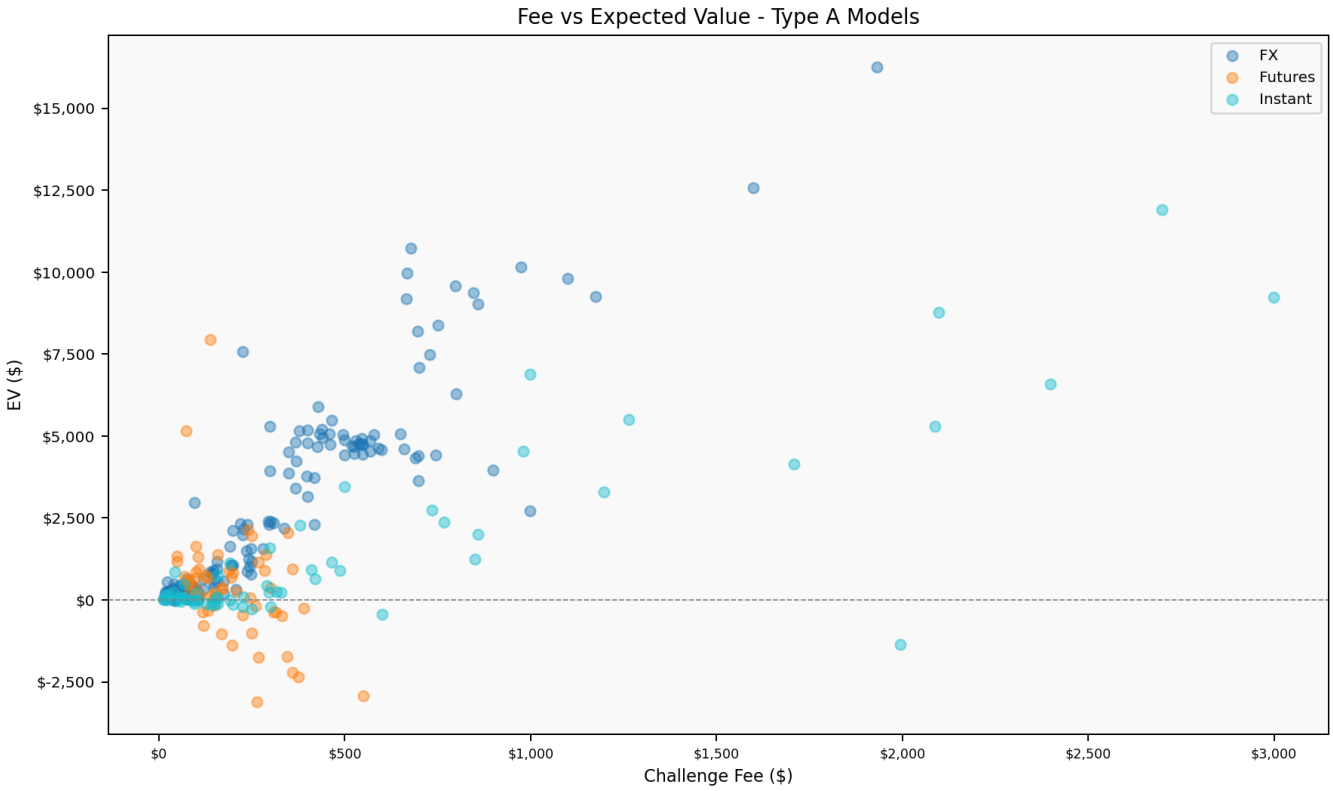
Size	Count	Mean Ev	Median Ev	Max Ev	Pos %
$25,000	9.00	$269	$251	$719	88.89
$50,000	15.00	$460	$616	$1,338	80.00
$75,000	1.00	70.79	70.79	70.79	$100
$100,000	16.00	$316	$479	$1,954	56.25
$150,000	14.00	$-284	$-115	$2,139	50.00
$200,000	2.00	$1,114	$1,114	$5,154	50.00
$300,000	1.00	$7,940	$7,940	$7,940	$100

Instant - EV by Account Size

Size	Count	Mean Ev	Median Ev	Max Ev	Pos %
$1,000	1.00	-4.72	-4.72	-4.72	0.0000
$2,000	3.00	-4.33	9.02	20.98	66.67
$3,000	2.00	-88.56	-88.56	-15.30	0.0000
$5,000	16.00	-1.89	24.64	$156	56.25
$7,000	1.00	$-114	$-114	$-114	0.0000
$10,000	8.00	13.07	27.52	$227	62.50
$15,000	1.00	85.72	85.72	85.72	$100
$20,000	2.00	30.66	30.66	$491	50.00
$25,000	6.00	$465	$347	$862	$100
$50,000	6.00	$1,058	$1,033	$1,593	$100
$100,000	7.00	$1,820	$2,275	$3,445	85.71
$150,000	2.00	$3,919	$3,919	$4,539	$100
$200,000	3.00	$5,513	$5,500	$6,890	$100
$250,000	1.00	$5,290	$5,290	$5,290	$100
$300,000	2.00	$7,678	$7,678	$8,765	$100

6.2 Fee vs EV Relationship

The scatter plot below reveals how challenge fees relate to expected value. Challenges with low fees relative to their EV represent the best cost-efficiency.



Fee-EV Correlations

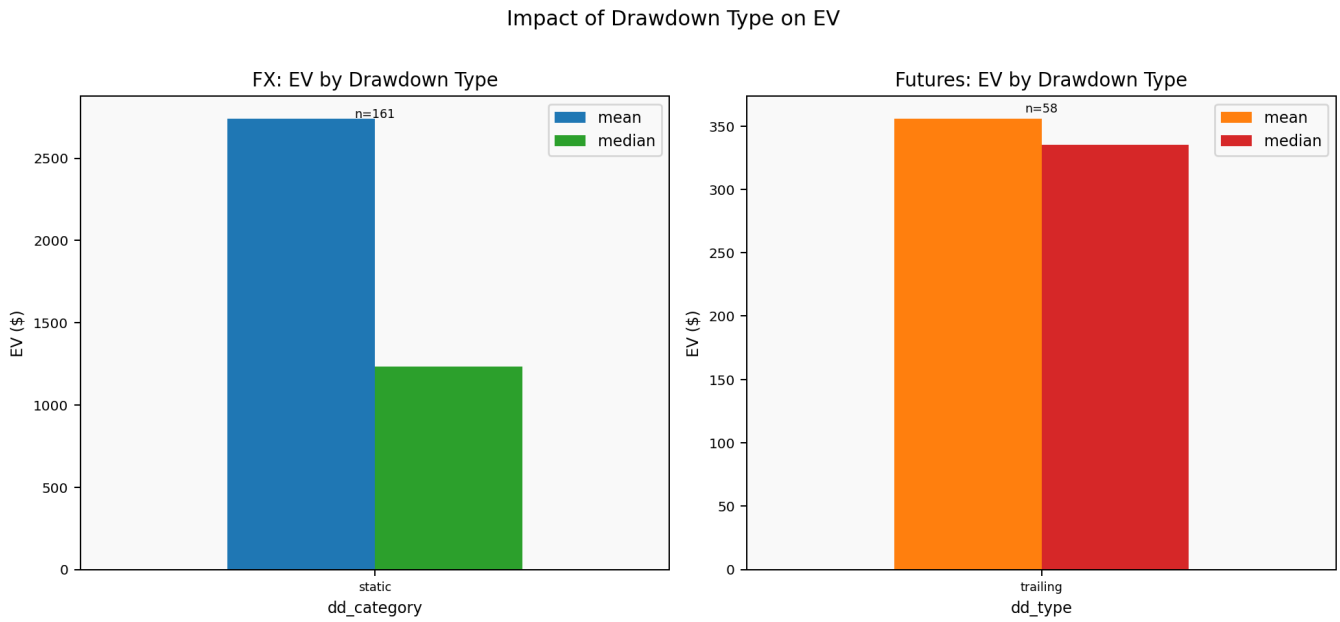
FX Type A: Fee-EV correlation = 0.9118

Futures Type A: Fee-EV correlation = -0.4081

Instant: Fee-EV correlation = 0.8495

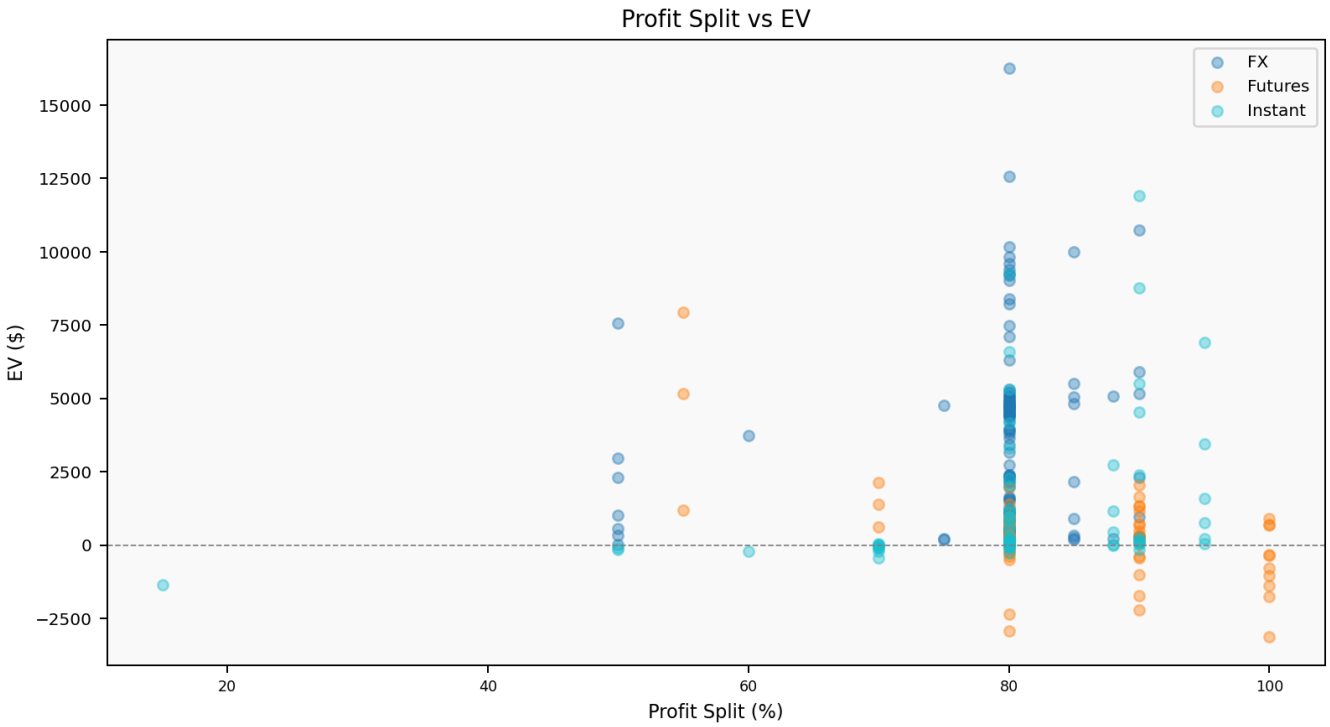
6.3 Drawdown Type Impact

Trailing drawdowns create compounding hedge costs (the insured base grows exponentially), while static drawdowns keep costs linear. The chart below quantifies this impact.



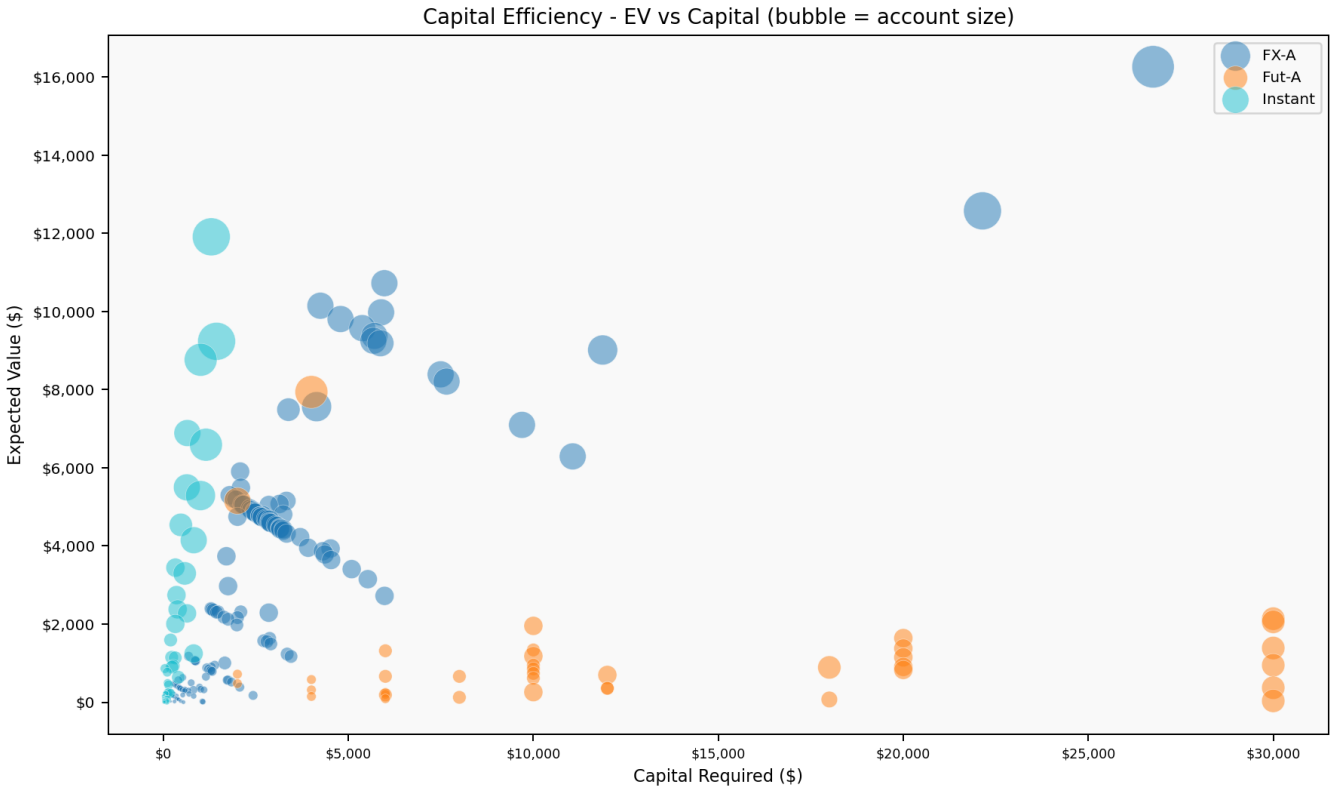
6.4 Profit Split Analysis

Higher profit splits directly increase funded payouts without affecting hedge costs. A 90% split vs 80% split adds 12.5% more to the funded payout.


Profit Split vs EV
FX
Futures
Instant
EV ($)
15000
12500
10000
7500
5000
2500
0
−2500
20
40
60
80
100
Profit Split (%)

6.5 Capital Efficiency

Capital efficiency measures how much EV is generated per dollar of required trading capital. High capital efficiency means better returns on the hedging capital deployed.



Top 10 Capital-Efficient - FX Type A

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Ev	Capital Require	Capital Efficie
FundedElite	100000	$299	$5,298	$1,791	2.96
AquaFunded	100000	$429	$5,904	$2,074	2.85
Instant Funding3.8	100000	$439	$5,206	$1,910	2.73
The5ers	5000	22.00	$260	95.74	2.72
FundedNext	100000	$400	$5,190	$1,967	2.64
Blue Guardian	100000	$464	$5,491	$2,094	2.62
BrightFunded	200000	$975	$10,148	$4,243	2.39
Goat Funded Trader	100000	$458	$5,072	$2,125	2.39
ATFunded	100000	$460	$4,749	$2,002	2.37
BrightFunded	100000	$495	$5,054	$2,154	2.35

Top 10 Capital-Efficient - Futures Type A

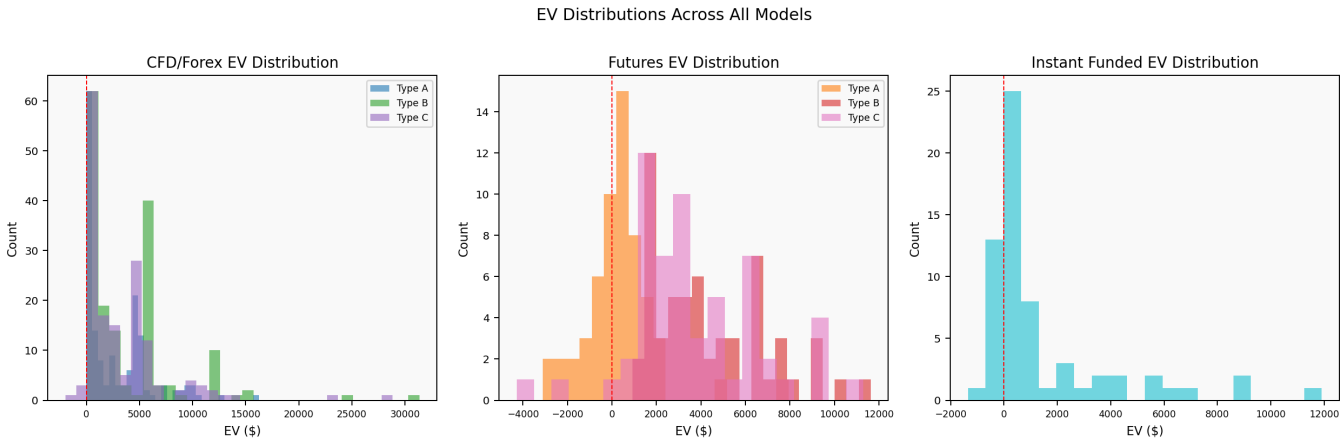
Firm	Account Size	Fee	Ev	Capital Require	Capital Efficie
Traders Launch	$200,000	74.00	$5,154	2000	2.58
Traders Launch	$300,000	$139	$7,940	4000	1.99
Top One Futures	$25,000	69.00	$719	2000	0.3594
Alpha Futures	$25,000	79.00	$477	2000	0.2387
Top One Futures	$50,000	$105	$1,317	6000	0.2195
FundedNext Futures	$100,000	$250	$1,954	10000	0.1954
FundedNext Futures	$25,000	79.99	$581	4000	0.1452
Topstep	$50,000	49.00	$1,338	10000	0.1338
Traders Launch	$100,000	49.00	$1,181	10000	0.1181
AquaFutures	$50,000	$100	$663	6000	0.1105

Top 10 Capital-Efficient - Instant

Firm	Account Size	Fee	Ev	Capital Require	Capital Efficie
FXIFY	$5,000	19.00	$156	7.12	21.87
Blueberry Funded	$25,000	42.50	$862	40.81	21.13
FundingPips	$200,000	$998	$6,890	$646	10.66
FundingPips	$100,000	$499	$3,445	$323	10.66
AquaFunded	$150,000	$980	$4,539	$470	9.67
AquaFunded	$400,000	$2,699	$11,912	$1,293	9.21
Blue Guardian	$5,000	27.00	$154	17.48	8.83
AquaFunded	$300,000	$2,099	$8,765	$1,006	8.71
AquaFunded	$200,000	$1,265	$5,500	$632	8.70
FundingPips	$50,000	$299	$1,593	$194	8.23

6.6 EV Distribution Histograms

Overlaid histograms for each asset class reveal the shape of EV distributions. Right-skewed distributions indicate a few high-EV outliers pulling the mean above the median.



Descriptive Statistics - EV Across All Models

Model	N	Mean	Median	Std	Min	Max	Skew
FX Type A	161	$2,740	$1,233	$3,059	-22.08	$16,264	1.42
FX Type B	161	$4,032	$1,937	$4,671	92.23	$31,359	2.34
FX Type C	161	$3,253	$1,604	$4,040	$-1,975	$28,849	2.83
Fut Type A	58	$356	$335	$1,660	$-3,118	$7,940	1.68
Fut Type B	58	$4,399	$3,689	$2,632	$922	$11,621	0.8150
Fut Type C	58	$3,673	$3,007	$2,880	$-4,280	$11,304	0.3600
Instant	63	$1,396	$156	$2,623	$-1,351	$11,912	2.24

7. Key Findings & Recommendations

1. Type B/C Consistently Outperform Type A

Across both FX and Futures, funded-continuation models (B and C) produce higher EV than challenge-only models. The funded phase generates recurring withdrawals that accumulate expected value over multiple cycles, while hedge drag is a smaller cost per cycle.

2. Static Drawdowns Are More Profitable Than Trailing

Challenges with static (balance-based) drawdowns produce significantly higher EV because the hedge cost remains linear. Trailing drawdowns create compounding costs that erode margins.

3. Larger Accounts != Better Capital Efficiency

While larger account sizes produce higher absolute EV, smaller accounts often have better capital efficiency (EV per dollar of required capital). The sweet spot varies by firm.

4. Payout Caps Severely Limit Futures EV

Many futures firms cap payouts at $1,000-$3,000 per withdrawal. This caps the funded payout and extends the break-even timeline. Uncapped or high-cap firms dominate the futures rankings.

5. Profit Split Is the Strongest EV Driver

A 10 percentage-point increase in profit split (e.g., 80% -> 90%) directly translates to ~12.5% more funded payout with zero additional hedge cost. Firms offering 90%+ splits dominate.

6. Instant-Funded Offers Are Capital-Light

Instant-funded models require significantly less capital than challenge-based models because there is no multi-phase evaluation to hedge through. They offer quick, low-risk opportunities.

7. Fee-to-EV Ratio Matters More Than Absolute EV

A $200 fee challenge with $100 EV (50% return) is often better than a $1,000 fee challenge with $300 EV (30% return). Cost efficiency and capital efficiency should inform selection.

Recommendations

1. Prioritize Type B model for challenges where capital allows continued funded-phase hedging.
2. Target firms with static drawdowns and >=90% profit splits for maximum EV.
3. For Futures, avoid heavily capped firms ($1K payouts) unless fees are very low.
4. Deploy initial capital into Instant-Funded offers for quick, low-risk EV generation.
5. Diversify across 3-5 top-ranked firms per model to reduce single-firm counterparty risk.
6. Re-run this analysis monthly as firms frequently update their challenge terms.
7. Consider Type C surplus only when comfortable with the additional capital requirements.
8. Focus on firms with >$100 EV in Type A as entry-level opportunities (150 FX + 36 Futures available).

Appendix A: Methodology

All models use a deterministic hedging framework. The hedge is a position that profits when the funded/challenge account moves against the trader (drawdown direction). The hedge is sized so that account drawdown = hedge profit, creating a zero-net-loss insurance mechanism.

Type A - Challenge Insurance

The insured base starts at the challenge fee. For each evaluation phase, the hedge loses as the account profits toward the target. For trailing drawdowns, the hedge is resized daily (compounding). For static, costs are linear. Total cost = (fee) x compounding factor. EV = funded_payout - total_cost.

Type B - Funded Recovery

Extends Type A into the funded phase. The funded account hedge is sized to recover the full accumulated cost stack if the account fails. Per-cycle: the trader withdraws a small profit (4% of account x split), while the hedge incurs drag (1.5% of account). Survival probability compounds at 80% per cycle over 6 cycles. EV_B = Sum(withdrawals) - Sum(drag).

Type C - Funded Surplus

Extends Type B with an additional surplus buffer (default 2% of account). The hedge covers L + P (stack + surplus), so on failure it recovers both. Drag scales proportionally by (L+P)/L. EV_C = Sum(withdrawals) + Sum(expected_surplus) - Sum(drag).

Instant-Funded

Single-phase model targeting a 5% first payout. Trading days are driven by consistency rules. Hedge cost depends on drawdown type (static vs trailing). Capital requirement based on peak hedge notional divided by leverage with 50% buffer.

Appendix B: Parameter Summary

CFD/Forex Parameters

Funded Target:	**8%**
Spread Cost:	**3 pips (0.03%)**
Resizes per Phase (Trailing):	**20**
Withdrawal per Cycle:	**4%**
Funded Cycles:	**6**
Survival Rate:	**80%**
Hedge Drag per Cycle:	**1.5%**
Surplus Target (Type C):	**2%**

Futures Parameters

Funded Target:	**6%**
Spread per Contract:	**$5 round-trip**
Default Consistency Threshold:	**20%**
Withdrawal per Cycle:	**4%**
Funded Cycles:	**6**
Survival Rate:	**80%**
Hedge Drag per Cycle:	**1.5%**
Surplus Target (Type C):	**2%**

Instant-Funded Parameters

First Payout Target:	**5%**
Spread Cost:	**3 pips (0.03%)**
Base Trading Days:	**5**
Default Leverage:	**100x**
Unspecified DD Treatment:	**Static**